Xiaomeng "Miranda" Zhu

+1-339-213-9411 | miranda.zhu@yale.edu | xiaomeng-zhu.github.io | xiaomeng-zhu

New Haven, CT 06511, USA

Education

- **Yale University** *August 2023 - Expected 2029*
  PhD candidate in Linguistics; M.A. in Linguistics (May 2026) New Haven, CT
  - Advisors: Robert Frank and R. Thomas McCoy
  - Dissertation: *Cues to Verb Learning: Computational Investigations with Large Language Models*

- **Wellesley College** *September 2019 - May 2023*
  B.A. in Computer Science & Cognitive and Linguistic Sciences (Honors); summa cum laude Wellesley, MA
  - Thesis: *The Modified Mother Tongue: Examining Chinese Vowel Quality Shift in Chinese-Dominant Chinese-English Code-Switching Environments*

Other Training

Linguistics Society of America Summer Institute 2025 Eugene, OR

Publications

Journal Articles

1. **X. Zhu**, K. Tang, J. Shaw. 2026. Independent Anti-reduction Effects Emerge from Form and Meaning: Evidence from Word Duration in Mandarin. *In preparation.*
2. **X. Zhu**, M. Niu, K. Tang, J. Shaw. 2026. Direct cueing of word identity through word duration: evidence from Mandarin homophones. *In submission to JASA.*
3. **X. Zhu**, R.T. McCoy, R. Frank. 2026. The Structural Sources of Verb Meanings Revisited: Large Language Models Display Syntactic Bootstrapping. *Open Mind*.

Peer-reviewed Conference Proceedings

1. Y. Luo*, C. Terlaak*, **X. Zhu***, A. Aravind. Complement Size and Epistemic Effects in Perception Reports. *CogSci 2026*.
2. **X. Zhu***, Z. Zhou*, S. Charlow, R. Frank. 2025. Meaning Beyond Truth Conditions: Evaluating Discourse Level Understanding via Anaphora Accessibility. *ACL 2025*.
3. Y. Wang, **X. Zhu***, W. Lyu*, S. Hassanpour, S. Vosoughi. 2025. ImpScore: A Learnable Metric For Quantifying The Implicitness Level of Language. *ICLR 2025*.
4. **X. Zhu** and R. Frank. 2024. LIEDER: Linguistically-Informed Evaluation for Discourse Entity Recognition. *ACL 2024*.

Presentations

Conference Posters

1. Y. Luo*, C. Terlaak*, **X. Zhu***, A. Aravind. Complement Size and Epistemic Effects in Perception Reports. *Poster presented at Sinn und Bedeutung 31*. Nantes, France.
2. **X. Zhu**, K. Tang, J. Shaw. Narrowing the Scope of Frequency and Informativity Effects on Word Duration: Experimental Evidence from Mandarin. *Poster presented at the 20th Conference on Laboratory Phonology*. Montréal, Québec, Canada.
3. D. DeCarlo*, W. Palmer*, L. van den Berg*, **X. Zhu***, M. Elbenni, S. Fernando, D. Koldobskiy, A. Ye, R.T. McCoy, R. Frank. Grounded Acquisition of Color Terms by a Computational Model. *Poster presented at Computational Psycholinguistics Meeting 2025.* Utrecht, Netherlands.
4. **X. Zhu***, Z. Zhou*, S. Charlow, R. Frank. Do LLMs Understand Anaphoric Accessibility? *Poster presented at the 8th Annual Meeting of Society for Computation in Linguistics (SCiL 2025)*. Eugene, OR, USA.
5. **X. Zhu**. A Dynamic Neural Field Model for Production Mode and Phonological Neighborhood Density Effects. *Symposium talk at Linguistic Society of America (LSA) 2025 Annual Meeting*. Philadelphia, PA, USA.
6. K. Liu*, **X. Zhu***, and C. Anderson. XiaoshuoNLP: An NLP Pipeline for Processing Chinese Literary Texts. *Poster presented at the New Directions in Analyzing Text as Data (TADA) 2023.* Amherst, MA, USA.

Invited Talks

1. **X. Zhu**. Multimodality. December 2026. Guest lecture for R. Thomas McCoy's class *Language and Computation*, Yale University
2. **X. Zhu**. Large Language Models and Cognitive Science. April 2026. Guest lecture for Athulya Aravind's class *Cognitive Science of Language*, Yale University

Research Affiliations

Yale Child Language Development Lab	2025 - present
Yale CLAY Lab	2023 - present
Yale Phonetics Lab	2023 - 2026
Wellesley College EASEL Lab	2022 - 2023
MIT Experimental Syntax and Semantics Lab	2021 - 2022
Wellesley College Sociolinguistics Lab	2022
MIT Media Lab	2020

Fellowships and Awards

Society of Computation in Linguistics Student Travel Award ($500)	2025
Wu Tsai Institute Graduate Fellow, *Yale University*	2023 - present
Sigma Xi, *Wellesley College*	2023
Phi Beta Kappa, *Wellesley College*	2023

Teaching

Teaching Fellow for **Language and Computation**, *Yale University*	Fall 2026
Teaching Fellow for **Cognitive Science of Language**, *Yale University*	Spring 2026
Teaching Fellow for **Topics in Computational Linguistics: Subregular Linguistics**, *Yale University*	Fall 2025
Tutor for **Foundations of Computer Systems**, *Wellesley College*	2022
Tutor for **Front-End Web Development**, *Wellesley College*	2020

Academic Service

Wu Tsai Institute Undergraduate Fellowship 2024, 2026
Application Reviewer
Yale DYNAMICS Reading Group 2026 -
Co-organizer
Yale Linguistics Department Colloquium Series 2024-2025
Co-organizer

Languages and Skills

Natural Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native), English (near-native), Spanish (intermediate)
Programming Languages: Python, Java, R, JavaScript, Racket
Frameworks: PyTorch, TensorFlow, spaCy